



Establishing a Healthy Workplace

If you employ people, you will need to consider their well-being in the workplace. By supporting your employees' physical and emotional health, you can help them reach their full potential.

Encouraging well-being

Well-being is a combination of feeling both physically and emotionally well. People with a sense of well-being tend to be more energized, motivated, and positive, as well as more resilient under pressure.

Employees with these qualities are likely to have a significant, beneficial impact on your business. Looking after your employees will enable them to perform at their highest level, and you can develop

a reputation as a business that cares for its staff, so prospective employees will be excited to join and contribute to the success of your enterprise. Poor well-being, with staff who are unable to work effectively or are absent altogether, has the opposite effect and can prove costly. According to a 2019 paper from the World Health Organization (WHO), depression and anxiety in companies of all sizes costs the global economy \$1 trillion per year in lost productivity.

Looking after employees' well-being

Studies into well-being at work show that employees need a sense of purpose. They want to feel that they are contributing to the success of the business, that their efforts are valued, and that they have some control over what they are doing—guidelines and instructions are useful, but it is more important for staff to feel that they have the autonomy to decide exactly how to do their work.

Employees must also be able to cope with the demands of the job. Providing appropriate training will help, but watch for signs of anxiety, and make sure that people know that it is all right to say if they have a problem.

Fairness



People who feel they are being treated fairly at work are more likely to be well motivated and positive. When you make a decision that affects someone, be transparent and open, and make sure they understand why you made your decision. Ensure pay and conditions are fair for all employees.

Appreciation



Thank people for their effort; even when something has not gone completely to plan, it will still help raise morale. Appreciation can be a financial reward or bonus, but simply expressing your thanks in public for a job well done is effective, too. Most importantly, your thanks must be genuine.

